

Chapter 122_2 - Jealousy

At this time, weak shouts came from within the thick miasma. Liu Wenzhu squinted her eyes to look: "It seems to be Sect Leader Tang. Yiyi, let's go over!"

The two followed the sound and indeed, after walking just a few steps, they bumped into Tang Wenshu, who was protecting his disciples and had just shattered a vengeful spirit to the ground with a sword technique.

"Sect Leader Tang, where are the others?" Liu Wenzhu shouted loudly, calling several times before hearing an echo.

"Except for the few people Fuyi brought, everyone else is here!" Tang Wenshu, who usually spoke gently, was shouting at the top of his voice. "Hua Feiwu is missing!"

When Ning Fuyi heard that Chu Qingqiu and Jiuying were not there, her heart immediately leaped up. She pushed Liu Wenzhu forward to Tang Wenshu and called out loudly: "I trouble Sect Leader Tang to look after Wenzhu. I'll go find them first!"

Without waiting for anyone to speak, she turned and plunged back into the thick miasma, disappearing from sight.

This miasma was truly strange. Although it was non-toxic and harmless when smelled, it isolated breath and voices. Ning Fuyi wandered in the miasma like a headless fly bumping around randomly. If not for her Emei thorns pointing the direction, she would probably lose her bearings.

She bumped into earthen walls and bricks several times, confirming that she had entered residential buildings. Just as she was about to turn back to the main street, her vision suddenly became clear.

Although not completely clear, she could already see things five steps away.

She was indeed in a collapsed courtyard. The surrounding walls could no longer be recognized in their original form, but the houses were still relatively intact. Even the ancient totems painted on the wooden doors could be seen clearly.

She stepped forward to look. The totem depicted a person holding a staff, with hair that was all black snakes, twisting in all directions.

Strange sounds came from within the door. Ning Fuyi leaned over to listen, but couldn't help making a disgusted sound and quickly moved her ear away, unwilling to hear the filthy sounds inside.

Presumably no one would be in such a romantic mood while within thick miasma. Since it wasn't human, it must be ghosts. Ning Fuyi shook her head and prepared to leave, but when she looked down and saw a line of footprints, she stopped again.

The footprints were so light they seemed to float on the surface, and the feet were small - a woman's.

"Chu Qingqiu?" Ning Fuyi quickly called out. Receiving no response, she forcefully pushed open the nearly rotten door and stepped inside.

The hall was full of dust. Ning Fuyi covered her nose and looked around, indeed seeing two lustful ghosts doing that sort of thing in the corner. Their pale ghost bodies actually had some allure. After smelling Ning Fuyi's presence, they looked up blankly and glared at her with four blood-red eyeballs.

"Don't mind me, continue what you're doing." Ning Fuyi covered her nose and waved at them.

The lustful ghosts weren't troublesome either. Upon hearing this, they obediently buried their heads and continued. Ning Fuyi looked away, not wanting to see more, and walked around them toward the inner room.

The woman was indeed inside, but her expression seemed wrong at the moment. She was staring fixedly at the ground. After seeing Ning Fuyi enter, she brushed her sleeve past her eyes and turned her back to her.

"You've come." Chu Qingqiu said.

"I came to find you. Where's Jiuying?" Ning Fuyi quickly walked over, standing behind her but hesitating to approach. "Why are you here?"

"What's wrong with me wanting to hide?" Chu Qingqiu said with her hands behind her back, her voice strange. "You have your own people to protect. My cultivation far exceeds hers, so you needn't worry."

Ning Fuyi was confused while also feeling a surge of anger. She reached out wanting to turn Chu Qingqiu around: "What nonsense are you talking about?"

This pull didn't make Chu Qingqiu turn around. Instead, it loosened her outer robe, earning a heavy push in return. Ning Fuyi's back hit the earthen wall with a dull thud.

"I told you I'm no longer your subordinate disciple, nor do I wish to be your junior, yet you still constantly put on airs and scold me. Chu Qingqiu, what exactly do you take me for!" Ning Fuyi nearly ground her silver teeth to dust, no longer caring about her words, exploding like a firecracker at the slightest touch.

"What do you take me for?" Chu Qingqiu suddenly turned around, tears at the corners of her eyes like falling petals, full of resentment.

She grasped Ning Fuyi's lapels with her delicate hands, pressing her firmly against the wall: "You just made a solemn vow, yet now you're flirting with other girls. She saved your life, while I'm the culprit who harmed you. She affectionately calls you sister, while I must carefully consider even calling you Yiyi once!"

"She's gentle as water, while I'm cold and silent. You've long grown tired of me, haven't you!" she said fiercely.

Ning Fuyi couldn't believe these were words coming from her mouth. Her mind became chaotic for a moment, malicious energy surging from her heart. She suddenly seized her arms and spun around, pinning her against the wall.

She used her full strength, making the entire house tremble.

The lustful ghosts outside suddenly stopped their panting sounds, seemingly curious about what was happening here. However, they were frightened by Ning Fuyi's sudden furious shout of "Do your thing!" and buried their heads to continue, their sounds louder than before.

"Are you talking about Baili Shiqi?" Ning Fuyi pressed her wrists against the wall. The pale wrists contrasted starkly with the dark wall, making her lotus-white arms appear even more soft and beautiful.

"Let go." Chu Qingqiu was so angry that the joints in her neck were protruding as she commanded.

Ning Fuyi's words were like breathing, gentle yet full of anger: "If I don't let go, are you going to lecture me again?"

Chu Qingqiu's eyes inevitably reddened. The malicious energy in the woman's phoenix eyes made her both heartbroken and desperate. She gritted her teeth: "Ning Fuyi, let go!"

Upon hearing these words, Ning Fuyi suddenly trembled all over. The reason that had been pushed out of her mind returned to occupy her brain. She stared blankly at the woman she had been restraining and quickly released her hands.

Chu Qingqiu's arms fell limply. As her chest rose and fell, a tear that had been accumulating for a long time fell from her eyes.

"This miasma is non-toxic and harmless, but it has this effect." Ning Fuyi shook her head to steady her mind. When she looked at Chu Qingqiu again, her steadied mind became chaotic once more.

She had never seen Chu Qingqiu with such a grieved expression, like flowers beaten by rain, standing there helplessly.

Chu Qingqiu didn't speak. She took out a green pill from her sleeve and said quietly: "Clear Heart Pill¹. Only one left."

After saying this, she reached out and forcefully pushed it to Ning Fuyi's mouth. The faint medicinal fragrance flowed over her teeth. Ning Fuyi said nothing but suddenly leaned forward and gently kissed her lips.

The medicine passed into Chu Qingqiu's mouth, slowly expelling the miasma's poison. Only after she felt the woman's breathing stabilize did she end the gentle kiss.

"I shouldn't have scolded you." Chu Qingqiu said. "I want to treat you well, but I'm used to acting that way and accidentally did it again."

"Actually, I don't mind that much either. It's all the miasma's fault, amplifying the resentment." Ning Fuyi wasn't used to Chu Qingqiu speaking this way and said in a low voice.

"I seem increasingly unable to control my mind. In the past, mere miasma couldn't affect me one bit." Chu Qingqiu closed her eyes tightly.

"But although I was extreme just now, everything I said came from my heart. That girl is clever and adorable. Naturally I don't dislike her, yet I also feel she surpasses me. So every time I see her looking at you with admiration, it's like jealous worms have grown here, dark and oppressive."

Chu Qingqiu seemed helpless about this version of herself. She lifted her eyelashes and smiled weakly: "Yiyi, I don't like myself being this way."

She wrapped her hands around Ning Fuyi's waist, pulling her close while also leaning into her embrace.

"I'm also afraid you'll grow disgusted."

Footnotes:

1. **Clear Heart Pill (清心丸)** - A medicinal pill that clears the mind and dispels mental disturbances or poisons affecting one's state of mind.